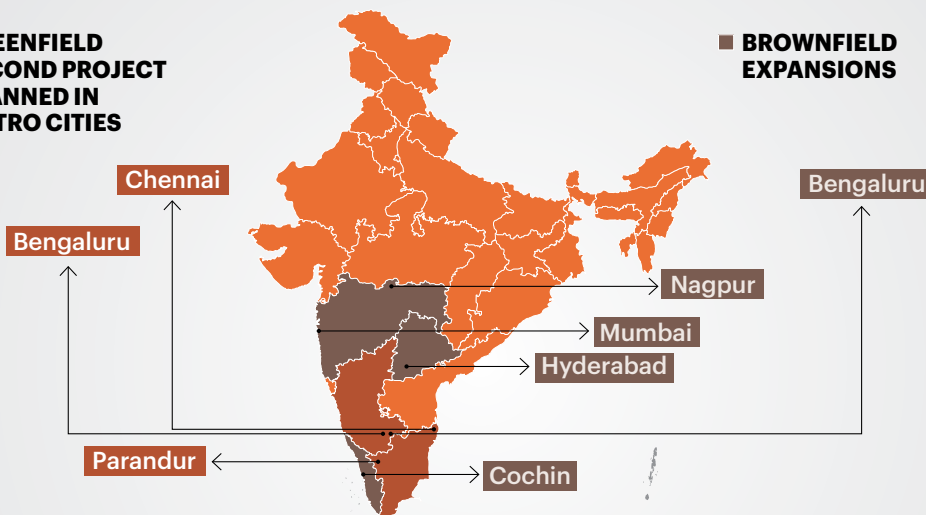


KEY EXPANSIONS

New airports would mean more flights connecting cities within India and destinations abroad, and would complement the massive expansion plans of domestic airlines

■ GREENFIELD SECOND PROJECT PLANNED IN METRO CITIES

■ BROWNFIELD EXPANSIONS



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PUBLIC-PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP

► 14 airports are operated under PPP. Navi Mumbai & Noida will make it 16; 11 more airports to go on sale by the end of FY26

OTHER PPP AIRPORT OPERATORS

► **Delhi, Goa, Hyderabad:** GMR Group
 ► **Kannur:** Government of Kerala (only promoter) has 39.23%, Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd 16.20%, M A Yusuff Ali (Lulu group) 8.59% and Airports Authority of India 7.47%
 ► **Cochin:** Government of Kerala

33.38%, M A Yusuff Ali (Lulu group) 12.11% and N.V. George (Geo Group of Companies) 5.93%. The rest have less than 5% share. The country's first PPP built Greenfield airport
 ► **Bengaluru:** Fairfax India Holdings Corp. 74%, Karnataka government and AAI 13% each

don't see these airports making a significant dent in Dubai or Doha until these cities and aero cities can offer facilities that are half as good as those offered by Dubai or Doha. At best, I see a 10% dent with greater connectivity and slots opening," says Lazar.

There is another hurdle. India has put a freeze on opening bilaterals, which means restricting frequency/capacity (seats) as demanded by airlines so that they can increase their flight frequencies. IATA work shows liberal ASA (air service agreement) frameworks help cities emerge as aviation hubs.

"The connectivity needs to be improved. Bilaterals of most nations have been exhausted, hence that will certainly be a dampener for growth, unless India opens those," says Lazar.

Gulf carriers have been pushing for expanded bilateral flying rights with India to meet rising passenger demand. However, the Indian government has kept these demands on hold to protect domestic airlines, many of which are yet to fully utilise their existing bilateral entitlements. While the European Union follows an open-skies policy with minimal restrictions, countries like